

Design Review Report

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Teaching Videos

List each teaching video you watched. For each one, write a real takeaway. What concept clicked for you? What surprised you or challenged an assumption you had? What impressed you about how your teammate demonstrated something? Take this seriously. Your teammates put real effort into these videos to teach you something you did not study yourself.

Video

I watched **EstherCarrasco**'s video on **CSS Marker, Backdrop, and Selection Pseudo-Elements**.

Takeaway

One thing that stood out to me was learning that these pseudo-elements target browser-generated content instead of elements directly written in HTML. I did not fully understand how things like list bullets or text highlighting could be styled separately before watching the video. The explanation of `::marker` was especially helpful because I learned you can customize bullets with colors, sizing, and even emojis, but only with a limited set of properties. I also thought the `::backdrop` demonstration was interesting because it showed how modal overlays can be customized with blur and gradients, while also explaining that backdrop does not inherit styles or tokens automatically. The section about `::selection` also connected well to accessibility because it emphasized maintaining proper contrast ratios when changing highlight colors. Overall, the video helped me better understand how browser-generated UI pieces can still be controlled through CSS.

Video

I watched **Esther Carrasco**'s video on **Custom Media in CSS**.

Takeaway

One thing that really stood out to me was the explanation of “magic numbers” in media queries and how custom media helps solve that problem. Before watching the video, I did not think much about how repeating the same breakpoint values across multiple files could create maintenance issues. The example showing a typo in one breakpoint value causing inconsistent layouts made a lot of sense and showed why reusable aliases are important. I also learned how custom media works together with PostCSS and a polyfill to compile modern syntax into standard CSS that browsers can understand. The live refactor demonstration helped me see how powerful it is to update a single breakpoint token in one file and automatically update the entire project during the build process. That connected well with what we have been learning about CSS architecture, tokens, and maintainable file organization.

Code Reviews

Review at least two teammates' Practice Site repositories. Look at their actual code for Choose Topic pages you did not build yourself. Each design review you should choose different teammates to review so that over the course of the semester you cycle through everyone on your team.

Review

I reviewed **Spencer Ashcraft**'s code for their **Lightning CSS** page.

What You Found

One thing I noticed while reviewing the project was how well organized the file structure and layering system were. The separation between tokens, components, and utilities made the CSS easier to follow and maintain. I also thought it was helpful how the project demonstrated the build pipeline working together with modern CSS features. Looking through the actual code made the concepts from the teaching video feel more practical, especially seeing how the compiled CSS was generated from the source files. I also liked that the project focused on keeping styles reusable instead of repeating values throughout the codebase. Overall, the project showed a strong understanding of CSS architecture and maintainable organization.

Review

I reviewed **Harrison Merrill**'s code for their **Attribute Selectors** page.

What You Found

What stood out to me most was how readable and organized the selectors were throughout the project. The examples made it easy to understand how attribute selectors can target elements in more specific ways without adding extra classes everywhere in the HTML. I also noticed that the CSS stayed fairly clean and easy to navigate, which made the page easier to learn from when reviewing the repository. Looking at the actual implementation helped me better understand how attribute selectors can simplify styling and reduce repetitive code in larger projects.

Check In

How Are You Doing?

I'm overall doing well. This week was a bit of a struggle for me. It took me a long time and I started to push up against the deadline despite giving myself plenty of time to work on the assignments. The part I am still working on is fully understanding where certain rules should go when they could fit into more than one layer or file. Reviewing other people's work helped because I could see different approaches to the same problems. Overall, I feel like I am making progress, but I would still like more practice with the build pipeline and making sure the bundled CSS is clean.